HONG (IVY) ZHAN

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Website | GitHub | LinkedIn

RESEARCH INTERESTS

HCI · Computational Social Science · Information Systems · Artificial Intelligence · Cyber Sciences

EDUCATION

University of York — York, UK Sep 2022 – Feb 2024

MSc in Social Media and Management

Relevant Coursework: Research Design · Understanding Social Media · Social Media, Data & Society

Wuchang University of Technology — Wuhan, China Sep 2017 – Jun 2021

BEng in Computer Science and Technology

Relevant Coursework: Probability & Statistics · Data Structures · Database Systems · Web Front-End Development

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Beyond the Aggregate: Trust and Distrust in Generative AI Across Technical Reddit Communities and Time

Sole-author research Feb 2026 – Oct 2026

Manuscript submitted to PACM HCI (CSCW) | Zenodo | GitHub

- Designed an archive-separated analysis of GenAI trust/distrust discourse across five Reddit communities, comparing pooled, community-, and half-year-stratified results.
- Analyzed 8,519 classification labels and 4,964 dimension records using Python/R, producing reproducible descriptive statistics and visualizations.
- Established measurement protocols for field provenance, denominators, and exceptions; adopted a replacement estimand for unavailable source-field mappings.
- Identified contrasting patterns: pooled Neither (41.7%) versus Trust-leading ChatGPTCoding (43.1%) and programming (46.2%), revealing aggregation's reporting limits.

Cross-Platform Social Media Use and Information Practices Among Chinese Students in the UK

MSc Dissertation Research | University of York Feb 2023 – Sep 2023

- Designed and conducted 15 semi-structured interviews (~60 minutes each) investigating cross-platform social media use and cultural adaptation among Chinese students in the UK.
- Transcribed and thematically coded interviews using NVivo, alongside analyzing social media posts to examine online participation and information evaluation.
- Identified themes of platform-specific communication, language barriers to participation, and cross-platform credibility checking amid perceived media differences.

Recruitment Management System

BEng Capstone Project | Wuchang University of Technology Feb 2021 – Jun 2021

- Investigated recruitment workflows through requirements analysis and translated user-centered needs into functional specifications for a web-based system.
- Designed interaction flows and interface prototypes, then implemented the system using Spring Boot and MySQL, covering job posting, application tracking, and candidate management.
- Conducted a usability evaluation with 8 participants via think-aloud tasks; findings informed iterative refinements to the interface.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Strategy Analyst | TikTok Shop, London, UK Mar 2025 – Jan 2026

- Analyzed UK e-commerce performance across merchant growth, product operations, and content-driven sales.
- Monitored business KPIs, investigated performance trends, and identified opportunities to improve merchant and product performance.
- Supported cross-functional strategic initiatives, business reviews, and operational process improvements.

Insights & Analytics Intern | Warner Bros. Discovery, London, UK Sep 2024 – Jan 2025

- Analyzed performance trends across UK digital media products and prepared reports for business stakeholders.
- Maintained weekly Film and TV digital sales reports, tracking content performance and release schedules.
- Supported market research and data analysis for marketing, digital distribution, and technical operations teams.

Founder & Operations Manager | Zero Point HR, Wuhan, China Aug 2019 – Sep 2022

- Built a recruitment operations platform coordinating ~30 staff and matching job seekers with employers across full-time and part-time roles.
- Designed workflows for candidate screening, shift scheduling, and placement tracking, handling 3,000+ full-time placements and 100,000+ part-time shifts.

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

Tech Volunteer | BetaNYC, New York, USA Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

- Supported open-data and civic-tech workshops by preparing NYC public datasets, creating accessible visualizations, and engaging residents on barriers to accessing government information.

Data Volunteer | DataKind, London, UK Dec 2023 – Jul 2024

- Collaborated in a DataDive to clean and analyze nonprofit service data with Python/Pandas, producing visualizations and a stakeholder briefing to inform program decisions.

International Student Buddy | University of York, York, UK Oct 2022 – Sep 2023

- Mentored international students transitioning to university life, providing practical guidance and connecting them with campus resources and student communities.

LANGUAGES & SKILLS

Research Methods: Research Design, Quantitative & Qualitative Analysis, Semi-structured Interviews, Thematic Analysis, Descriptive Statistics, Data Validation, Data Provenance & Reproducibility.

Programming & Tools: Python (pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib), R, SQL, NVivo, Git/GitHub, LaTeX.

HCI & Systems: Requirements Analysis, Interaction Design, Interface Prototyping (Figma), Web Development.

Languages: English (fluent); Chinese (native).